

Hector Taylor

Doctoral Candidate

Psychedelic Research and Therapy Development Group

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Education

Sept. 2024-May 2028 Universität Zürich - University of Zurich

PhD. Candidate, Psychology

Dissertation (working title): *Virtual Reality and Psychoplastogens: A Synergistic Approach for the Treatment of Chronic Pain*

Advisors: Dr. Prof. Milan Scheidegger, Dr. Felix Schollkmann

Aug. 2019-May 2021 Arizona State University

B.S. in Psychology (Cognitive), Magna Cum Laude

Thesis: *Visuomotor Recalibration to Multi-Modal Cues in Virtual Environments*

Advisor: Dr. Michael McBeath

Aug. 2016-Dec. 2018 Northern Arizona University (Transfer)

Thesis: *Sex from the Margins: Charting the Trajectories of Reproductive Health in Bangladesh, Pakistan, and India across Differential Revolutions.*

Advisor: Dr. Sanjam Ahluwalia

Research experience

Feb. 2025-Present **Graduate Student Researcher** - Neurophotonics and Biosignal Processing Research Group, Biomedical Optics Research Laboratory, University Hospital Zurich, University of Zurich

Supervisor: PD. Dr. Felix Schollkmann

Sept. 2024-Present **Graduate Student Researcher** - Psychedelic Research and Therapy Development Group, University of Zurich, Psychiatrische Universitätsklinik, Zentrum für Psychiatrische Forschung

Supervisor: Dr. Prof. Milan Scheidegger

Aug 2022-July 2024 **Laboratory Manager / Research Assistant** - Virtual Environment Navigation lab, Brown University, Department of Cognitive, Linguistic, and Psychological Sciences

Supervisor: Dr William Warren Jr.

Sep. 2019-May 2021 **Lead Research Assistant** - Perception Ecological-Action Robotics and Learning Lab (PEARL).

Arizona State University, Department of Psychology.

Supervisor: Dr. Michael McBeath

Mar. 2020-May 2021 **Research Assistant** - Embodied Games Lab

Arizona State University, Department of Psychology

Supervisor: Dr. Mina Johnson-Glenberg

Apr-2020-May 2021 **Research Assistant** - Mobile Experiential Technology through Embedded Optimization Research Studio
Arizona State University, School of Arts, Media & Engineering | School of Electrical, Computer & Energy Engineering
Supervisor: Dr. Robert LiKamWa

Aug. 2017-Jan. 2019 **Research Scholar** - School of Women's and Gender studies
Northern Arizona University, Interns to Scholars program
Supervisor: Dr. Sanjam Ahluwalia

Invited Talks

“Virtual Reality and Psychoplastogens: Paving the way toward Pharmacologically Augmented VR Treatments” *Qualia Research Institute and ALIUS Research Network workshop on Altered States of Consciousness*, Crete, July 2025.

“Reshaping the Self: Psychoplastogens and Embodied Virtual Reality” *The Future of Education in Virtual and Augmented Reality* (Invited Talk). Future of Education in Virtual and Augmented Reality talk series, Arizona State University. April 2025.

“Virtual Reality and Psychoplastogens: Paving the way toward Pharmacologically Augmented VR Treatments” *Swiss Psychedelic Student Network Talk Series* (Invited Talk). University of Basel, May 2025.

Publications:

Johnson-Glenberg, M.C., Jehn, M., Chung, C.-Y., Balanzat, D., Zavala, R. N., Apostol, X., Rayan, J., **Taylor, H.**, Kapadia, A., Bartolomea, H. (2021). Interactive CovidCampus simulation game: genesis, design, and outcomes. *Frontiers in Communication*. 6,657756. <https://doi.org/10.3389/fcomm.2021.657756>

Johnson-Glenberg, M.C., Jehn, M., Chung, C.-Y., Balanzat, D., Zavala, R. N., Apostol, X., Rayan, J., **Taylor, H.**, Kapadia, A., Bartolomea, H. (2021). Covidcampus game: making safer choices. In *7th International Conference of the Immersive Learning Research Network (iLRN)*. IEEE. <https://doi.org/10.23919/ilrn52045.2021.9459315>

Ahluwalia, S. and **Taylor, H.** (2019). Reproduction: Health: Bangladesh and Pakistan. In *Encyclopedia of Women & Islamic Cultures*. https://doi.org/10.1163/1872-5309_ewic_COM_002202

Conference Presentations and Posters

Taylor H., Ho, J. Scheidegger, M., Schollkman, F., Lengenhagger, B. Schweinhardt, P. (2025, July). Virtual Reality and Psychoplastogens for Chronic Pain: Paving the way toward pharmacologically augmented VR Treatments [Poster Presentation], Association for the Scientific Study of Consciousness, Heraklion, Greece.

Yoshida, K. **Taylor H.**, & Warren W.H. (2024, November). The influence of Explicit and Covert Leaders on Human Crowd Motion [Oral Presentation], Traffic and Granular Flow 2024, Lyon, France.

Yoshida, K., **Taylor, H.**, & Warren W.H. (2024, May). Can covert and explicit “leaders” steer and split real human crowds? [Poster Presentation]. Vision Sciences Society, St. Pete’s Beach, FL, USA.

Taylor, H. (2021, April). Multi-Modal Influences of Slant Perception in Virtual Environments. [Poster Presentation]. Arizona Psychology Undergraduate Research Conference, Tempe, AZ, USA.

Leadership and Mentorship

Sept. 2024-Present	Psychedelic Research Organization Zurich Co-President Treasurer Author and Recipient of GRC Short Grant for Spring 2025 Talk series
Aug. 2022-July 2024	Research Mentor, <i>Virtual Environment Navigation Lab</i> (Brown University) Honors undergraduate thesis, CLPS: Brayson Freeman, Lucia Tian Undergraduate Research assistant: Christine Wu, Kira Kelly Clarke, Mahnoor Elahi, Salma Eldeeb
Aug 2019-Aug. 2021	Research Mentor, <i>Perception Ecological-Action Robotics and Learning Lab</i> (Arizona State University) Mentees: Dylan Board, Jeremy Cummins, Morgan McAlphin
Aug 2017-Aug. 2019	Senior Mentor, <i>Research Apprentice mentoring program</i> (Northern Arizona University) Mentees: Raumilya Smith, Tessa Fletcher
Aug. 2018-Aug. 2019	Vice president - <i>Student Undergraduate research club</i> (Northern Arizona University)
Aug. 2018-Aug. 2019	Vice President - <i>Research Apprenticeship Mentoring Program</i> (Northern Arizona University)

Work and Volunteer Experience

Jan. 2022 - Aug. 2022	Clinical Research Coordinator , Adams Clinical Trials, Cambridge, Massachusetts
May. 2021 - Jan. 2022	Clinical Data Quality Control Analyst , Celerion Clinical Trials Tempe, Arizona
Aug. 2020 - Aug. 2021	Change Agent , Changemaker Central, Arizona State University, Tempe, Arizona
Aug. 2019 - Mar.2020	Staff Volunteer , Phoenix Downtown Farmers Market, Phoenix, Arizona

Awards

2019 - Smith Marshall Scholarship Winner
2018 - NAU Merit Scholarship Winner
2017 - Outstanding Entry award NAU film fest

Technical Skills

Software & Frameworks: Unity, PyTorch, Git, MongoDB, Blender, SLURM
Programming Languages: C#, Python, Java, R, Javascript